

ASTERISCO*

Concept Overview

Move. Meet. Explore. Together.

“Come with us.”

A working reference document for Asterisco's identity, model and content — built as a brief for website design and copywriting.*

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- 1. Identity & Vision** — *What Asterisco is, the problem it solves, and its long-term vision.*
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1. Identity & Vision

What Asterisco* Is

Definition

Asterisco* is a women-led community and umbrella organization that connects women through sport, movement, nature and shared experiences. It is not a sports club and not a single event series — it is a platform that removes the barriers standing between women and an active, connected, outdoor life, and gives women the tools and support to lead their own initiatives within it.

Two levels at once

- As a community — creates accessible, non-judgmental spaces where women can try new sports, spend time in nature, meet other women, and learn from one another.
- As an umbrella structure — supports individual women who have an idea for an event or activity, helping them find partners, venues and a first experience of real leadership, while Asterisco handles the scaffolding around them.

Core conviction

Movement and leadership are deeply connected — and both are still harder for women to access freely than they should be.

The Problem

For many women, access to sport, the outdoors, and freedom of movement is still limited by cultural, social, emotional and structural barriers: not knowing anyone to go with, not knowing how to start a sport, fear of judgment or of not being “good enough,” a lack of welcoming entry points, and a persistent gender gap in sport, outdoor activity and leadership roles.

These barriers rarely disappear on their own — they need spaces designed specifically to remove them: low-pressure, non-competitive, beginner-first, and built around relationships rather than performance.

Vision

We imagine a world in which women can freely inhabit their own bodies, move without fear, and step into leadership — of their own choices, their shared activities, and their communities. Sport becomes a tool for connection, confidence, and belonging, not a performance to be judged.

Long-term, Asterisco* aims to grow into a recognized international movement: a network of active local communities, connected globally, that continues to grow beyond any single event and becomes a lasting source of connection, wellbeing, empowerment and environmental awareness.

2. The Umbrella Model

This is the core structural idea of Asterisco, and what makes it more than a series of events.*

Two Sides of Empowerment

a) Leading — the event creators

Any woman with an idea for an event — a sport she wants to introduce, a topic she wants to raise, an experience she wants to create — can bring it to Asterisco*. Together, Asterisco* helps her find partners, a venue and the practical pieces she needs; she takes care of the content, promotion and delivery. It is a co-creation process where Asterisco* supports every step, but the woman with the idea is in the lead: deciding, organizing, and owning the outcome. For many, this is a first real experience of leadership and responsibility — and consistently, both the women who lead and the Asterisco team describe this as deeply empowering.

b) Participating — the community members

The second layer is the women who come to try, connect and grow through the events themselves. Barriers are broken down by offering access and space to try something new alongside other women — a place to exchange knowledge, attempt a sport for the first time, or simply meet people. This is paired with reflection and dialogue: each event is also an opportunity to raise a question, share knowledge, or open a debate about something that matters.

Asterisco* deliberately treats these as two sides of the same empowerment process, not two separate programs — leading an event and participating in one both build the same muscles: confidence, autonomy, connection, and a sense of ownership over one's own body and choices.

Peer Learning: Women Learning From Women

A defining feature of Asterisco* is that expertise flows horizontally, between women, rather than top-down. Events are consistently built around a woman who already knows something — how to fix a bike, how to climb, how to think about nutrition and movement, how to play padel — sharing that knowledge directly with others in an approachable, pressure-free setting. It is not “come learn from us,” it is “come learn from each other, with us alongside you.”

City	What happened
Porto, Portugal	First-time bouldering session removed the barrier of “needing someone to explain how it's done” — over 20 women tried the sport for the first time in one afternoon.
Turin, Italy	A woman with bike-repair expertise ran a workshop so participants would feel confident enough to go on long rides, even alone — which grew into a series of group bike rides.
Turin, Italy	A nutrition expert led a social run and picnic built around a debate on women and food: challenging the historical focus on calorie restriction and weight loss, and reframing it around “nurturing the movement.”
Stjørdal, Norway	A first padel event, run in partnership with a local club, gave 11 women their first experience of the sport in a single weekend.

The pattern is consistent: someone in the community already has the knowledge or skill, Asterisco* creates the structure for her to lead and share it, and the group grows its collective capability together.

3. Nature, Community & Blog

Nature, Environmental Awareness & Reflection

Asterisco* treats the outdoors as more than a backdrop for activity — it is central to how the community builds resilience, both individually and collectively.

- Outdoor activities and time in nature are core community-building practices: they offer freedom of movement, a shared sense of discovery, and a setting away from performance pressure and everyday expectations.
- Asterisco* draws a deliberate parallel between the way women's bodies are subject to control, judgment and pressure, and the way the natural world is subject to exploitation — and treats reconnecting women with nature, through movement and shared experience, as a source of care, solidarity and resilience for both.
- Every event is also a space for dialogue: alongside the activity itself, Asterisco* raises topics worth reflecting on together — the gender gap in sport and outdoor leadership, the relationship between the body and nature, self-love and accepting one's own limits and desires, and what it actually takes for a woman to move from participating to leading.

Asterisco* is explicit that it doesn't claim to have the answers — the goal is to open honest conversations and support women in questioning their own routines and assumptions, together. This combination — movement outdoors + open reflection on real topics — is what turns a one-off activity into something that builds long-term awareness and community strength.

Community Structure

Focal points / local communities

Currently active in Portugal (Porto), Italy (Turin) and Norway (Trondheim/Stjørdal), with new focal points forming in Berlin, Geneva, Toulouse and Madrid.

In person

Locally organized events — sports try-outs, workshops, group activities, discussions — run by local leads with Asterisco's support.

Online

A home base on Instagram (@asterisco.wld) and a website in development (asteriscoworld.com) sharing stories, events and the community's development; local WhatsApp groups (e.g. Asterisco Trondheim) that stay active long after an event ends, with members proposing hikes and activities on their own initiative — a sign the community keeps living outside of organized events.

Weekly challenges

Low-threshold weekly challenges (in development) on Instagram, encouraging people to try something new with minimal barrier to entry.

Blog / Stories & Research (website feature)

The website will include a blog page — a space that goes beyond the polished “who we are” content to hold the community's actual voices and thinking. It will be open to:

- Women who led an event, writing about the experience of organizing and leading it — what they learned, what scared them, what it felt like to be in charge.
- Women who participated, sharing personal stories: trying a sport for the first time, a friendship that started at an event, a moment of growth or confidence.
- Reflections and debates raised at events — nutrition and the body, the gender gap in sport and leadership, body image, self-love and limits, women and nature — written up so the conversation can continue beyond the people in the room.
- Community-led research findings, published as they develop, so the research stays visible and useful to the community it comes from, rather than locked away in a report.
- Environmental reflections, connecting movement and nature to the broader themes Asterisco cares about.

The blog reinforces the peer-to-peer, “come with us” identity: it isn't Asterisco publishing content about women, it's women publishing their own stories and thinking, with Asterisco providing the platform. It also naturally builds the “Stories & Inspiration” section already planned in the sitemap, and should highlight diversity — different bodies, backgrounds, sports and countries.

4. Brand Identity

Core Messaging

Mission

Connecting women through sports, movement and nature.

Slogan

Move. Explore. Belong.

Brand phrase

Come with us.

In three words

Community. Movement. Exploration.

Personality

If Asterisco were a person

She's adventurous, open-minded and kind — the one who invites everyone in, introduces strangers to each other, and makes people feel included. She loves being active and discovering new places, and pushes others (gently) out of their comfort zone. She isn't driven by competition or performance. She's confident without being intimidating, inspiring without being preachy, ambitious without losing sight of care and connection.

Personality adjectives

Welcoming, empowering, adventurous, inclusive, curious, vibrant, authentic, down-to-earth, optimistic, human, playful.

Positioning

- Grassroots, not top-down
- Beginner-friendly, not performance-driven
- Accessible, not exclusive
- Inspiring, not authoritative
- Bold, not subtle
- Community-driven, not corporate
- Modern, not traditional
- Welcoming, not intimidating
- Adventurous, while staying approachable

Tone of Voice

Warm, accessible and human rather than expert or institutional. “Come with us” rather than “learn from us” or “follow us.” Encouraging participation and exploration while staying genuine and supportive. Playful and energetic, but professional enough for partners, sponsors and funders.

Mechanically (per Brand Guide v1, 2026): warm, direct, first-person plural (“we”). We ask questions instead of giving answers. Lowercase headlines, short sentences. The asterisk (*) replaces exclamation marks.

Example lines

- “first time? perfect*”
- “your idea. your event. we back you up*”
- “who said this isn't for you?*”

Visual Identity

Per Brand Guide v1, 2026 — this supersedes any earlier color/typography direction.

Symbol

The asterisk (*) remains the core symbol — something small but essential, the mark in a form that draws attention to what matters most; a metaphor for the role women often play in society: overlooked, yet fundamental.

Color palette

Asterisco Violet #46287C <i>primary</i>	Lilac Mist #E9E1F6 <i>secondary / light</i>
Paper White	Deep Ink

#FCFBF8 background	#1B1430 text / dark
Coral Clay #FF8A70 seasonal accent — primary	Open Sky #A8D8E8 seasonal accent — outdoor line
Fern Trail #7BAE6F seasonal accent — nature/growth line (proposed)	

Typography

- Shantell Sans — display font for headlines; hand-drawn energy; words rotated $\pm 3^\circ$
- Marcellus — wordmark and formal titles only
- Space Grotesk — body text, captions, meta rows, UI

Photography direction

Natural light, real women mid-movement, no posing for the camera. Light backgrounds, soft grain, motion blur welcome. Never competitive scoreboards or “before/after” imagery.

Visual language

Should still evoke movement, connection, nature, exploration and collective experience — bold, warm and modern, never overly corporate, aggressive, hyper-competitive, or built on stereotypical femininity.

Logo approach

Wordmark + symbol combination (Asterisco* + the asterisk).

Note: the Brand Guide's mission line (“Sport as a tool for empowerment, self-knowledge and leadership — by women, for women.”) differs slightly in emphasis from the Mission line above (“Connecting women through sports, movement and nature.”) — worth confirming which is the current preferred phrasing before briefing the website copy.

5. Audience, Partnerships & Status

Who It's For

Primary audience

Women roughly 18–40 looking for community, connection and ways to be active — including women new to a city, international students, young professionals, travelers and digital nomads, and anyone wanting to try new sports or spend more time outdoors.

Secondary audiences

Local organizations, sports clubs, municipalities, sponsors, female athletes, NGOs and institutions interested in women's empowerment, community-building, wellbeing and environmental resilience — as partners and collaborators, not competitors.

What Makes Asterisco Different

Asterisco* doesn't treat sport as an end goal or a route to competition — it treats it as a tool for connection, confidence, exploration and leadership. It doesn't position itself against sports clubs, women's organizations or local community groups, but as a complement to them: a connective layer that makes existing activities more accessible and turns them into entry points for leadership, friendship and reflection. Most other communities focus on one sport; Asterisco is intentionally cross-sport, letting women move between climbing, cycling, running, padel, hiking and whatever comes next, learning from each other along the way.

Partnerships

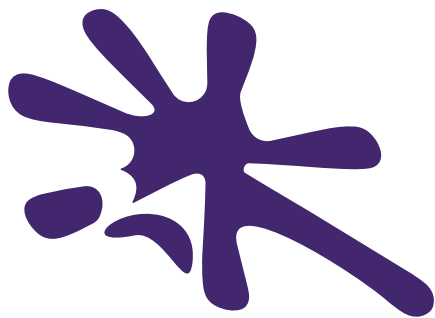
Asterisco* is seeking collaborations with organizations registered in the EU that are active in the social sector and experienced in working with young people, grounded in horizontal exchange, mutual learning and collective strengthening — as well as local partners (venues, sports clubs, experts, sponsors) who can host or support individual events.

Current Status

Asterisco* is an early-stage, women-led initiative, currently run alongside its founders' other commitments. It is in the process of formal registration in Norway, where its administrative base sits, with future plans to enroll in Norway's public grassroots-funding scheme (Grasrotandelen). A website (asteriscoworld.com) is in development, and the community's primary digital home today is Instagram (@asterisco.wld) alongside local WhatsApp groups.

Events to date have taken place in Porto, Turin, Trondheim and Stjørdal, with new local communities forming in Berlin, Geneva, Toulouse and Madrid.

FINALLY, OUR LOGO:



ASTERISCO